Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – General Inflammation Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023043
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- For individuals with acute hematogenous osteomyelitis, measurement of C-reactive protein (CRP) (CPT code 86140, CPT code 86141**) **IS REIMBURSABLE** once every two days.

- Measurement of erythrocyte sedimentation rate (ESR) (CPT code 85651*, CPT Code 85652*) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following conditions at the designated frequency:

  - Acute and chronic urticaria: as needed
  - Ankylosing spondylitis: as needed
  - Hodgkin lymphoma: one test every three months
  - Nonradiographic axial spondyloarthitis: as needed
  - Periprosthetic joint infections: as needed
  - T-cell lymphoma: as needed
  - The following signs and symptoms of irritable bowel syndrome: as needed:
    - Abdominal pain or distension
    - Abnormal stool color
    - Blood or mucus in stool
    - Bulky stools
    - Constipation
    - Diarrhea
    - Fecal abnormalities
    - Incomplete defecation
    - Melena
    - Nausea
    - Vomiting
  - The following signs and symptoms of large vessel vasculitis: as needed:
    - Abdominal pain
    - Abnormal weight loss
    - Fatigue
    - Fever of unspecified origin

  - Non-pressure ulcers
  - Other specific skin findings associated with large vessel vasculitis
  - Skin eruptions
  - Skin rash

- Measurement of CRP (CPT code 86140, CPT code 86141**) or ESR (CPT code 85651*, CPT code 85652*) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following conditions at the designated frequency:

  - Arthritis: one test every month
  - Giant cell arteritis: one test every month
  - Takayasu arteritis: one test every month

- For the conditions for which CRP (CPT code 86140, CPT code 86141**) or ESR (CPT code 85651*, CPT code 85652*) testing is allowed, as outlined above, measurement of ESR **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** when billed in conjunction with CRP.

- For all conditions not addressed above, measurement of ESR (CPT code 85651*, CPT code 85652*) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- Measurement of CRP (CPT code 86140, CPT code 86141**) or ESR (CPT code 85651*, CPT code 85652*) during a general exam without abnormal findings **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
85651*	Sedimentation rate, erythrocyte; non-automated
85652*	Sedimentation rate, erythrocyte; automated
86140	C-reactive protein
86141**	C-reactive protein; high sensitivity (hsCRP)

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
CGS Administrators, LLC	MolDx: Biomarkers in Cardiovascular Risk Assessment	L36139	86141
First Coast Service Options, Inc.	Sedimentation Rate, Erythrocyte	L34021	85651 85652
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, Inc	MolDx: Biomarkers in Cardiovascular Risk Assessment	L36358	86141
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, Inc	MolDx: Biomarkers in Cardiovascular Risk Assessment	L36362	86141
Palmetto GBA	MolDx: Biomarkers in Cardiovascular Risk Assessment	L36129	86141

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
WPS Insurance Corporation	MolDx: Biomarkers in Cardiovascular Risk Assessment	L36523	86141

** The payment criteria for 85651 and 85652 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to First Coast Service Options.*
***The payment criteria for 86141 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to CGS Administrators, Noridian Healthcare Solutions, Palmetto GBA, and WPS Insurance Corporation.*

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